

4. Who was the founder of Chola dynasty?
- (a) Vijayalaya (b) Karikal
(c) Aditya first (d) Rajaraja first
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The Chola Empire was founded by Vijayalaya, who was initially a feudatory chieftain of the Pallavas. He captured Tanjavur in 850 A.D. The Shiv temple of Tanjavur, Rajarajeswara or Brihadeeswara temple was built during the time of Rajaraja I.

5. Which of the following dynasties is not mentioned in Sangam literature?

- (a) Kadamb (b) Chera
(c) Chola (d) Pandya

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The origin and elevation of Chola, Cheras and Pandyas are mentioned in Sangam Literature. Kadamb or any other dynasty is not mentioned in Sangam literature.

6. Why was 'Uraiyur' famous in Sangam Era?

- (a) An important trade centre of spices
(b) An important trade centre of cotton
(c) An important centre of foreign trade
(d) An important centre of domestic trade

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Uraiyur was a very significant town during Sangam Era, located on the bank of Cauvery River in Tiruchirappalli (Tamil Nadu). It was known as Koli and Varanam and was the major centre of cotton. It is mentioned in "Periplus of the Erythraean Sea."

Ancient Literature and Litterateur

1. Who of the following was the writer of Mudrarakshasa?

- (a) Aswaghosha (b) Vishakhadatta
(b) Kalidasa (d) Bhasa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Mudrarakshasa written by Vishakhadatta is a drama in Sanskrit. Although written during the Gupta period, it describes how Chandragupta with the assistance of Kautilya overthrew the Nandas. It also gives a picture of the socio-economic condition under the Mauryas.

2. 'Kumarasambhava,' an epic poem was composed by –

- (a) Banabhatta (b) Chanda Bardai
(c) Harishena (d) Kalidasa

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

The famous books of Kalidasa: - Abhigyanashakuntalam, Kumarsambhavam, Malavikagnimitram, Meghadutam etc.

3. What is the name of Kalhana's book?

- (a) Arthashastra (b) Indica
(c) Purana (d) Rajatarangini

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Rajatarangini was written by Kalhana.

4. Name the source that is silent about the trade routes of ancient India:

- (a) Sangam Sahitya (b) Milindpanho
(c) Jataka Tales (d) All of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Sangam Sahitya is silent about the trade routes of ancient India.

5. The author of 'Swapnavasavadatta' is

- (a) Kalidasa (b) Bhasa
(c) Bhavabhuti (d) Rajshekhara

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

'Swapnavasavadattam' is a Sanskrit play written by great poet Bhasa.

6. Which of the following Indian Philosophy has given the theory of atom?

- (a) Yoga (b) Justice
(c) Sankhya (d) Vaisheshik
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

According to Vaisheshika philosophy, the universe is created from Atoms. Maharshi Kanad was the originator of this philosophy.

7. Who wrote the book "Kiratarjuniya"?

- (a) Bhatti (b) Shudrak
(c) Kalidasa (d) Bharavi

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)